

OPEN CALL

FERTILITY: Invisible Journeys



Submission Guidelines & Terms and Conditions

An exhibition exploring the unseen stories of fertility, subfertility, infertility and reproductive health.

THE EXHIBITION

Stories that deserve to be seen.

Fertility: Invisible Journeys is an open exhibition that invites artists and creatives to explore the diverse realities of fertility and reproductive health. We welcome work that reflects the biological, emotional, social, cultural, and environmental dimensions of fertility, helping to raise awareness, encourage conversation, and reduce stigma.

We encourage diverse interpretations of these themes and welcome work that challenges assumptions, sparks dialogue, and promotes greater understanding.

Themes

- Fertility, subfertility and infertility
- Assisted reproduction and fertility treatment
- Pregnancy loss and reproductive grief
- Reproductive health and wellbeing
- Environmental and societal influences on fertility
- Personal lived experiences of subfertility and infertility

WHO CAN APPLY?

All perspectives are welcome.

- Visual artists
- Digital and mixed-media artists
- Sculptors
- Textile artists
- Printmakers
- Individuals with lived experience

No previous exhibition experience is required.

ACCEPTED MEDIA

What you can submit.

- Painting
- Photography
- Drawing
- Printmaking
- Sculpture
- Textile art
- Mixed media
- Video or short film
- Short story

Size requirements:

- All 2D works must be no larger than A2.
- All sculptural works must not exceed 100cm in height.

SELECTION PROCESS

How works will be selected.

- A selection committee of five jury members will select the works for the exhibition.
- Selection will be conducted blind.
- The committee will comprise practising artists, gallery staff and individuals with lived experience of subfertility.
- The committee brings together artistic, curatorial and lived-experience perspectives.

SUBMISSION & ARTIST COMMITMENT

What selected artists need to commit to:

- Artists must be able to deliver and deinstall their work in person.
- Work must be delivered to Oaklands Social on Saturday 14 November, from 10am to 2pm.
- You will be asked to help with 1 to 2 half-days of invigilation from 10am to 2pm.

KEY DATES

Submission and exhibition timeline.

- **Submission deadline** Friday 2 October
- **Notification of selection** Sunday 18 October
- **Delivery of work** Saturday 14 November, 10am–2pm
- **Install date** Sunday 15 November
- **Exhibition** Monday 16 November – Saturday 28 November
- **Private view** Thursday 19 November
- **Take down and collection of work** Sunday 29 November

VENUE

Oaklands Social – Bow Arts

Oaklands Social, Oaklands House, Old Oak Common Lane, London, NW10 6DU

- Nearest station(s): North Acton (Underground), Willesden Junction (Overground/Underground)
- Bus: 260, 266, 440, 487, BL-1, BL-2
- Parking: No Parking
- Bike: Yes

TERMS & CONDITIONS

Submission terms

1. Eligibility

The open call welcomes the applicant groups and perspectives described in these guidelines. No previous exhibition experience is required.

2. Submission

- Submissions should respond to the exhibition themes and use one of the accepted media listed above.
- **Artists may submit a maximum of two artworks for consideration as part of this open call.**
- All wall-based or 2D artworks must be framed and ready for installation. Exceptions may be considered at the discretion of the organising team where the nature of the artwork requires an alternative method of presentation. Artists should clearly state any specific framing, mounting or installation requirements in the application form under “Notes on artwork”.

3. Selection

- Works will be selected by a five-member selection committee through a blind selection process.
- The committee comprises practising artists, gallery staff and individuals with lived experience of subfertility.
- Selection will be based on the work’s thematic relevance to the exhibition, as well as its suitability in terms of scale and dimensions for display within the gallery

4. Size

- All 2D works must be no larger than A2.
- All sculptural work should not exceed 100cm.
- Artists will need to provide their own plinths for sculptural work.

5. Delivery and deinstallation

- Selected artists must be able to deliver and deinstall their work in person.
- Delivery is scheduled for Saturday 14 November, from 10am to 2pm, at Oaklands Social.

6. Exhibition

Selected works will be exhibited at Oaklands Social – Bow Arts from Monday 16 November to Saturday 28 November.

7. Costs

- This is a self-funded, not-for-profit project.
- There is no fee to participate in the exhibition.
- No commissions are taken for any sales you make.

7. Insurance

- You will be required to have your own public liability insurance and artist insurance.
- You will be asked to complete a short risk assessment for the Gallery.

7. Copyright, reproduction and promotional image permissions

By accepting selection for the exhibition, the artist grants the organising team a non-exclusive, royalty-free licence to photograph, reproduce and publish images of their submitted artwork for the purposes of documenting, promoting and publicising the exhibition. This includes, but is not limited to, use on the exhibition website, social media platforms, press materials and other promotional communications. The artist will be credited wherever reasonably practicable.